Yang Tongle: Okay, let's add a chicken dish and a...
Wang Yixue: There are only three of us—no need to order so much.
Yang Tongle: Got it. Let's start with these dishes for now.
Wang Yixue: Oh, by the way, my son's birthday is next week. If you're free, come over to my place—I'll cook some Beijing dishes for you.

课文 2

Wang Yixue: It's our first time having the new neighbors over—I keep worrying that we might have missed something.
Liu Ming: Don't worry, I've double-checked everything. We're all set.
Wang Yixue: I thought I already took out the drinks—where did they go?
Liu Ming: I put all the drinks and alcohol in the fridge. We'll take them out when the guests arrive.
Wang Yixue: Does the music volume sound okay?
Liu Ming: You've turned it up too loud. I'll lower it a bit.
Wang Yixue: Alright, let's wait for the guests now.

课文 3

Wang Yixue: Thank you all for coming to my son's birthday party. I hope everyone has a wonderful time tonight.
Yang Tongle: Happy birthday, Xiaoming! I brought a small gift for you—I hope you like it!
Liu Xiaoming: Thank you! May I open it now?
Yang Tongle: Of course. Your mom mentioned that you love painting, just like your sister. Is that right?
Liu Xiaoming: Yes, I want to be a painter someday. Wow—a drawing board and paintbrushes. This is exactly what I wanted. I love it so much!
Wang Yixue: I'll go get the plates. How about we have some cake and chat for a while?

课文 4

My new neighbors are a couple from the United Kingdom. Last week, I visited their home. They prepared a lot of delicious food and even served British tea. That day, we chatted over tea until after midnight. When they were young, both of them loved traveling. There's a world map in their home, and each red dot on the map represents a place they've visited. Later, they became fascinated by Eastern culture and started learning Chinese. Today is Xiaoming's birthday, and I've invited them to my home to experience a Chinese household and try some Chinese cuisine.

Lesson 14 这本书被别人借走了

课文 1

Li Wen: The dictionary I borrowed is due today, but I don't have time to return it.
Bai Jiayue: I only have two classes this afternoon, so I can help you return it to the library.
Li Wen: Thank you so much! Could you also help me borrow another book?
Bai Jiayue: Sure, just tell me the title.
Li Wen: I'll write it down for you. I've been to the library several times, but this book is always checked out.
Bai Jiayue: *Stories of Celebrities*? I have that book—I'll lend it to you tomorrow.

课文 2

Annie: Classes ended early today. What are your plans for later?
Bai Jiayue: I'm really busy today. First, I need to go to the library to borrow some books, and then I'm going swimming.
Annie: Let's go together. I want to check out some Chinese newspapers at the library.
Bai Jiayue: Wait a minute—my campus card is missing. I won't be able to enter the library

without it.
Annie: Do you remember when you last used it?
Bai Jiayue: I don't remember. Maybe I left it at home.
Annie: It's okay if you can't get into the library. You can look for e-books online instead.
Bai Jiayue: No, I have to go—I have to return Li Wen's book.

课文 3

Li Wen: There's a school party next week. Have you heard about it?
Bai Jiayue: Yes, a few other girls and I are going to perform. Are you joining too?
Li Wen: I want to sing a Chinese song, but I haven't found anyone to perform with yet. I'm not sure what to do.
Bai Jiayue: If you can't find anyone, just perform solo.
Li Wen: Just thinking about performing in front of the principal, teachers, and so many classmates makes me a bit nervous.
Bai Jiayue: What's there to be nervous about? We all love hearing you sing. You just need to believe in yourself.

课文 4

Yesterday was our school's New Year's party, and students from every class put on performances. The party started at 8 p.m. and didn't end until nearly midnight. I spent the whole evening singing and dancing with everyone—it was so much fun, but I was completely worn out. My favorite act was the dance by the international students. Toward the end, even the teachers and the principal were invited to join the dance floor, which made it especially entertaining. In a few days, the videos will be uploaded to the school's website, and I'm planning to watch them again.

Lesson 15 我是半个南京人

课文 1

Yang Tongle: You've been living in the Lantian Neighborhood for a while now. How do you like it?
Wang Yixue: The surroundings are quite nice, and it's very convenient for shopping. There's a supermarket right across the street.
Yang Tongle: Where do the kids usually play?
Wang Yixue: There are plenty of trees in the community, so after school, the kids play games under them. Are you thinking about buying a house?
Yang Tongle: Yes, I want to buy a big house so my parents can come and live with me.
Wang Yixue: There are quite a few elderly people in Lantian Neighborhood, and in recent years the community has made many changes to suit them.
Yang Tongle: That sounds great! I'll go check out Lantian Neighborhood in a few days.

课文 2

Wang Yixue: I'm thinking of going to Nanjing for the vacation, but I don't know much about it.
Yang Tongle: Although I'm not from Nanjing, I went to university there, so I'm basically half a local.
Wang Yixue: That's great! Could you tell me more about Nanjing?
Yang Tongle: Nanjing has a history of over 2000 years. It's got ancient city walls, historic streets, and famous landmarks. It attracts countless tourists every year.
Wang Yixue: Besides those popular tourist spots, do you have any recommendations for hidden gems?
Yang Tongle: There are so many! It would take a while to list them all.
Wang Yixue: Sounds good. Let me buy you dinner after work, and we can chat over a meal.

课文 3

Wang Yixue: Xiaoming, there is a major river in China named after a color. Do you know which river it is?
Liu Xiaoming: I know! It's the Yellow River!
Wang Yixue: That's right. Here's another question—do you know why it's called the Yellow River?
Liu Xiaoming: It's because the water looks yellow! By the way, is the Yellow River the longest river in China?
Wang Yixue: No, the Yellow River isn't the longest, but it is historically very important.
Liu Xiaoming: I know! A long time ago, many Chinese people lived along the Yellow River.
Wang Yixue: Exactly. To us Chinese, the Yellow River is like a mother—it has nurtured us for thousands of years.

课文 4

When I was little, I lived in the northwest part of Beijing, where a very famous river flowed by. My home was right by the river. There were tall trees and lush green grass all around. In spring, flowers along the riverbank would bloom, making the scenery especially beautiful. I still remember that every summer, I would go swimming in the river. As I grew older, whenever I felt unhappy, I would sit under the trees by the river, listening to the birds, watching the flowing water, and chatting with friends I met there. My sadness would melt away in no time. That's my favorite place.

Lesson 16 我听说有的熊猫出国了

课文 1

Liu Xiaoxue: How long have you been taking care of this kitten?
Staff: Over a year now. When we first found it, it was dirty and tiny.
Liu Xiaoxue: Now it's so clean and beautiful!
Staff: Exactly! It's also super cute—sometimes it sleeps by your feet, and sometimes it climbs all over you.
Liu Xiaoxue: You've really taken great care of it.
Staff: It feels like it's our own child. We take care of it, and now it knows us.
Liu Xiaoxue: Mom, can we get a kitten?
Wang Yixue: We don't have time to take care of one. How about I take you to the Beijing Zoo this weekend to see the animals instead?

课文 2

Liu Xiaoming: Mom, the Chinese name "giant panda" sounds so strange. What do they have to do with cats?
Wang Yixue: That's a great question. They have nothing to do with cats. Actually, they should be called "Giant Cat-Bears".
Liu Xiaoming: Why do giant pandas only eat bamboo and not meat?
Wang Yixue: They can eat meat, just like us, but they're simply not interested in it.
Liu Xiaoming: Why are giant pandas considered China's national treasure?
Wang Yixue: China is the only country with wild giant pandas—it's their natural home.
Liu Xiaoming: I heard some pandas have been sent abroad. Where did they go?
Wang Yixue: That's a long story! I'll have to tell you about it bit by bit.
Liu Xiaoxue: Little brother, you're like a walking "One Hundred Thousand Whys".

课文 3

Liu Xiaoxue: This giant panda keeps climbing up and down—it's so adorable!
Wang Yixue: It seems like it's still hungry. Look, it's standing up with its mouth open, trying to find something to eat.
Liu Xiaoxue: The panda next to it hasn't moved in a while. Is it sleeping?
Wang Yixue: I can't see its face, so maybe it is.